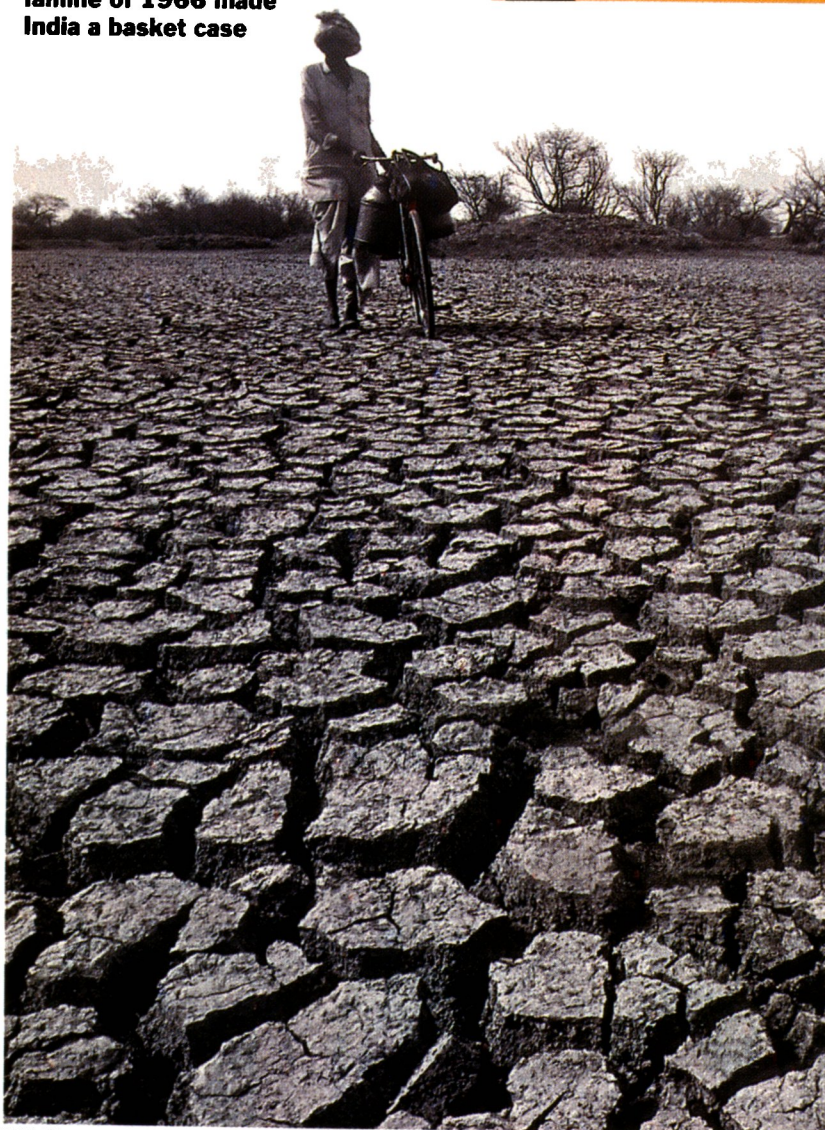


NO CONFIDENCE

HUNGRY HORIZON: The famine of 1966 made India a basket case

◀ **REWIND**



SAIBAL DAS

India seemed on the point of peril. With failed monsoon for two successive years 1965 and 1966, India saw a severe drop in food production, and an unprecedented increase in foodgrain supply from the US. US President Lyndon Johnson put wheat supplies on a short tether. He refused to commit food aid until an agreement to adopt the green revolution package was signed between the two countries. On the fiscal front, foreign aid, which was hitherto a key factor in preventing devaluation of the rupee, was finally cut off and India was told that it had to liberalise its restrictions on trade before foreign aid would again materialise. India had never looked so vulnerable and Indira Gandhi, who was made the prime minister at 48 by the Congress syndicate led by K. Kamaraj (described once as a cross between Sonny Liston and The Walrus), appeared unequal to the task her father and Lal Bahadur Shastri had handled so well.

FIRST CUT

Reita Faria (right) became the first Indian to win the Miss World title. By winning the crown, she led the way for her successors. After her year-long tenure, she turned down modelling and film assignments and instead concentrated on medical studies in Ireland, where she still lives with husband David Powell.



◀ **DID YOU KNOW**

Homi Jehangir Bhabha, considered the father of India's nuclear weapons programme, died when Air India's Boeing 707 Kanchenjunga crashed in a snowstorm at Mont Blanc on January 24.